
TAKEAWAYS

- ° If you can afford it or are able to acquire it through work, get health insurance. Yes, the provider will try to get out of paying for care you need, but it will at least lower the amount of debt you have if something serious happens.
- ° Always check with your insurance or doctor about whether something is covered. You don't want to be surprised by a bill you thought insurance would handle. This sucks and involves calling customer service or nitpicking your doctor's recommendations, but it is worth avoiding hundreds or thousands of dollars of surprise debt for something you could have gone without.
- ° Expect many, many unexpected bills at every stage of becoming a parent. Plan for them. Prepare to spend more than you'd anticipated. Babies come with all kinds of surprises. Look into the free services available to you as a new parent. There are more than you'd think!
- ° Vote! Vote for elected officials who support some form of universal health care and who support reproductive rights. If we've learned anything in the past few years, it's the importance of voting.
- ° We should be able to make our own reproductive decisions. They're intricately tied to finances, and we need to be trusted with our own bodies. Restricting abortions and birth control and who can afford to have sex maintains the economic and class status quo, and it's cruel and dehumanizing.

